

Q Simmtronics has launched a 25.4-cm (10-inch) tablet —the XPAD X-1010—in the Indian market. Not many players have ventured into this screen-size segment. What prompted you to explore this space?

We are a tablet manufacturing company. So, our focus has been to bring out offerings across the board. Launching a 25.4-cm (10-inch) tablet is a part of that strategy. Also, I feel that consumers are looking at tablets as their source of entertainment while on the go. Watching videos and playing games is a totally different experience on a tablet of this size. We, being a technology company, work to have an edge over others with our innovations and technology. A 25.4-cm tablet is one such offering. It has been accepted well across the country.

Q What is your strategy for selling these tablet devices?

We want to target the age group of 15-28 years with our tablet devices. We design our products keeping the needs and aspirations of only this target group in mind. We have been working through our distributor and channel network for the sale of our devices. We have recently joined hands with HCL for the distribution of our devices. I am sure this is going to boost the presence and availability of Simmtronics devices tremendously, particularly in the regions we were not able to reach till now. Also, we are looking to enter into tie-ups with Large Format Retail (LFR) chains.

Q Apart from manufacturing your own products, do you manufacture products for other OEMs as well?

Yes, we manufacture products for about seven different OEMs in India including Micromax and Sahara. Apart from these, we manufacture for three international OEMs as well.

Q One major criticism of Simmtronics tablets is that they look pretty similar to Micromax's offerings. How would you respond to that?

Well, I don't think we are similar to Micromax's offerings in any way. We are much better than them in many ways. In addition to a great package of features and

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specifications, with our tablet devices, the customers get free Wi-Fi access in 5000 outlets across the country including McDonalds, CocoBerry, Cafe Coffee Day, etc. I can claim that the advantages that we are offering, no tablet company has offered before. So we clearly have the upper hand. Simmtronics was recently ranked as No 3 amongst tablet manufacturers globally. The speed at which we can deliver new technologies and customise a product as per market requirements is our USP and makes us different from any of the Indian players, at least.

Q What about after sales service for your products?

We have around 500 service centres across India, so after sales service is not an issue for our products.

Q It is now time for phablets. What is your take on this growing segment?

The phablet is the combination of a smartphone and a tablet, starting from a size of 12.7-cm (5-inch). If someone thinks that 'phablets' can replace tablets, they are mistaken. The experience is totally different. A smartphone, irrespective of its screen-size, cannot cater to the requirements that a tablet can meet. Tablets have a different set of applications and offer an entirely different experience. You may be able to watch a video on a smartphone but it is certainly not the ideal device to watch a movie on. This is where tablets play a role. We like to call our 12.7-cm devices as smartphones and not phablets.

Q So you don't buy Samsung's concept of phablets?

No, I am not too convinced with this logic that there can be a hybrid of smartphones and tablets. Both the devices have their own features and experiences to offer.

Q Any reasons for choosing Android as a platform for all your devices and not Windows 8?

Yes. First, Windows 8 has its own limitations. For modern day tablets and smartphones, Android has become the default. Android has a couple of open source alternatives already. Ubuntu for smartphones and tablets looks attractive. We will be watching out for developments with respect to Ubuntu but will take a final call on how the eco-system shapes up. As far as Windows 8 is concerned, we do not have any immediate plans to work with the software. **END** 

